# REVIVING A **FORGOTTEN LEGACY**

**A 150-year-old heritage structure, dating back to colonial times gets a second life that honours its rich past and the breathtaking Himalayan backdrop**

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**Photographs by INCLINED STUDIO**



**CUSTOM COMFORT**
Rich timber, carved detailing and traditional plasterwork (left); a restored guest room

Perched within the mist-laden folds of the Dhauladhar hills in Dalhousie, Himachal Pradesh, Terrah Hills stands today as a testament to the revival of a forgotten era. Nearly 150-years-old, spread over 1.2 acre, this heritage structure carried the silence, scars and soul of colonial hill architecture when we first encountered it. Weathered by decades of neglect, it still possessed an unmistakable architectural identity and a remarkable historical narrative; including the legacy of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose, who once stayed at the property. From the outset, our vision was never confined to mere restoration. We sought a true architectural and craftsmanship revival, allowing the building to breathe again through its authentic character.

### Unearthing the Stone Narrative

What initially appeared to be layers of deteriorated plaster soon revealed the project's defining discovery. Beneath decades of concealment lay an extraordinary raw stone masonry structure, rich in texture and authenticity. The moment these original stone walls emerged, the direction of our entire design process transformed from replacing history to unveiling it.

Because the original walls were constructed with traditional mud mortar, they had naturally weakened over time. To preserve them without compromising their historic integrity, we introduced a polymer-based protective treatment over the exposed mortar joints. This structural intervention strengthened the resort while retaining its raw, earthy soul. In areas where the original masonry